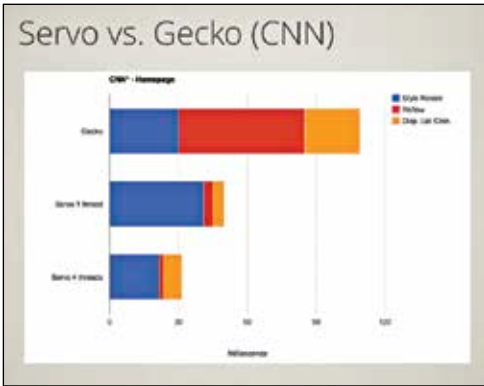




Servo is already passing the ACID2 test, and has remarkably better performance than current the Firefox Gecko engine.

many of the power features of low-level languages like C, such as pointers. In fact since it has started development at a time when multi-core computers are so popular, it also makes it simpler than ever to write multi-threaded applications.

One of the big goals of Rust is to be a safe language despite being low-level; to not let

performance compromise safety. This has lead to some interesting design choices for the language.

Rust takes many cues from functional programming languages, and has many features — such as patten matching — that will be familiar to those who like functional languages. In fact variables in Rust are immutable (meaning they can't be modified after assignment) by default.

While Rust was started by Graydon Hoare as a personal project at Mozilla at this point Rust is a community driven project. This is the perfect opportunity then, to get onto Rust on the ground floor, and not only learn a language that might be significant some day, but to shape it.

Significance

Rust is a language that is still very much in development, so its future is hard to evaluate right now. Given that it has been around for 5 years, is still going strong, and that it has a large organisation like Mozilla behind it, it won't simply disappear off the face of the Earth suddenly one day. It is also a language strongly tied to the development of Mozilla's future browser, so it has at least one major software baked in.

The syntax and semantics of Rust are still in flux. This can certainly be a negative for those trying to learn a language. Especially to find that the perfectly good program run one day and fail in the very next release. However, for those interested in studying programming languages, and their development, this is a great opportunity.